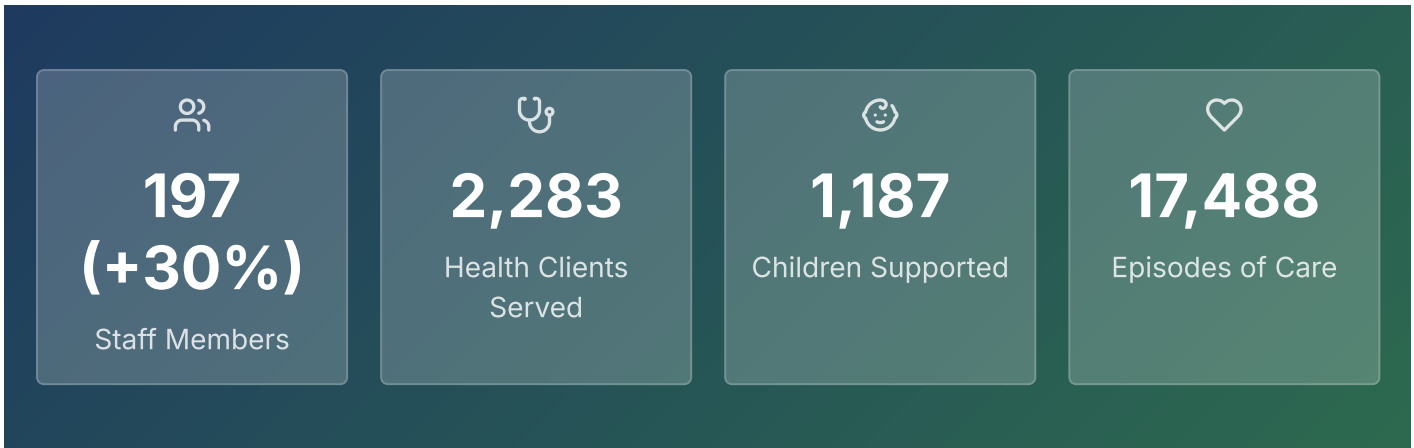


PALM ISLAND COMMUNITY COMPANY

Palm Island Community Company Annual Report 2025- 26 2026

Our Community, Our Future, Our Way

"Our Community, Our Future, Our Way"



Executive Summary

A Year of Growth, Resilience, and Community

Palm Island Community Company (PICC) has had another transformative year in 2023-2024. As the only Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander community-controlled organisation on Palm Island, we continue to deliver essential services while advancing self-determination.

Key achievements this year include:

- Staff growth of 30% to 197 employees, with 70%+ being Palm Islanders
- Implementation of Delegated Authority under the Child Protection Act - a decades-long goal achieved
- Launch of the First 1,000 Days program for maternal and child health
- Health service delivery to 2,283 clients with 17,488 episodes of care
- Support for 1,187 children through Safe Haven
- Revenue of \$23.4 million

Our 16 services span health, family support, justice, disability, crisis intervention, and economic development - all delivered by community members for community members.

Our Community, Our Future, Our Way

Message from Our Chief Executive Officer

R

Rachel Atkinson
Chief Executive Officer



It is my pleasure to present the 2023-24 Annual Report for Palm Island Community Company.

The pace at which PICC has been evolving is nothing short of remarkable. Our expanded investment in services has significantly strengthened and enhanced them, making them more robust and effective than ever before.

We now employ 197 people - three times the number compared to ten years ago - and our turnover has quadrupled to \$23.4 million. This substantial growth is directly benefiting Palm Islanders, either through the services we provide or the jobs we offer.

Impressively, 70%+ of our workforce are Palm Islanders - figures that are extraordinarily high compared to other services in remote communities.

A significant shift for children in care on Palm Island has occurred this year, with the community now deciding the care arrangements for children who cannot stay at home. This implementation of Delegated Authority is a change that has been fought for over decades.

I want to thank our Board, led by Chair Luella Bligh, our dedicated staff, our partners, and most importantly, our community members who trust us to serve them.

Together, we continue building a brighter future for Palm Island.

Our Community, Our Future, Our Way

Rachel Atkinson
Chief Executive Officer

Rachel

Rachel Atkinson



Year at a Glance

Key achievements from 2023-24

1

Staff increased 30% to 197 employees - 70%+ are Palm Islanders

2

Implemented Delegated Authority - community now decides care arrangements for children

3

Launched First 1,000 Days program for maternal and child health

4

Delivered health services to 2,283 clients with 17,488 episodes of care

5

Supported 1,187 children through Safe Haven service

6

Revenue of \$23.4 million supporting 16 services

7

Renewed RACGP Quality Practice Accreditation (next 2027)

8

Presented at SNAICC Conference in Darwin - Children & Family Centre storyline

9

Digital Service Centre supporting 50 languages through Telstra partnership

197

Total Staff

30% growth

23.4M

Revenue

Annual budget

70%

Local Employment

Community jobs

16

Services

Programs delivered

"When the cyclone hit, we lost everything. But this community - we came together like family always does. The young ones helped the Elders first. That's how we do things here on Palm Island."

Aunty Mary

Community Elder

Innovation in Action

Projects transforming our community

innovation

In Progress

Palm Island Photo Studio

On-Country professional photography and visual storytelling

[Read more](#) →

Planning



infrastructure

The Station

Community hub and cultural space

[Learn more →](#)

In Progress



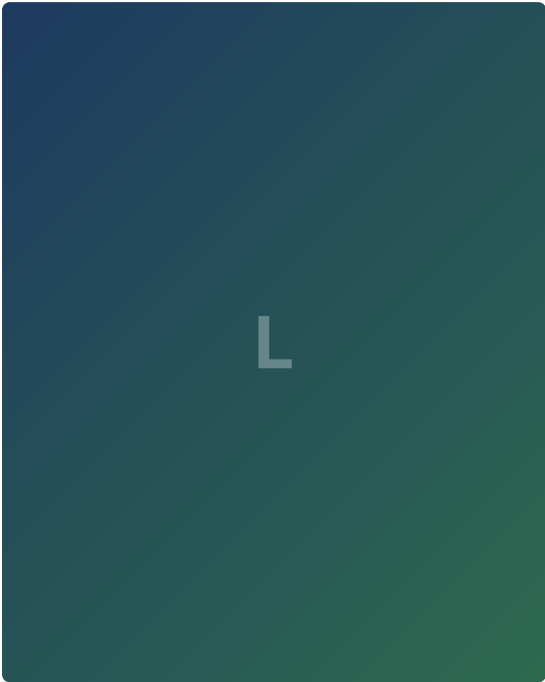
cultural

Elders Cultural Trips

Connecting elders to Country and preserving knowledge

[Learn more →](#)

Message from Our Board Chairperson



Luella Bligh
Board Chairperson



As Chair of the Palm Island Community Company Board, I am proud to share this year’s report with our community.

PICC exists to serve Palm Island — to deliver strong services, create meaningful local jobs, and keep decision-making in community hands. This year we have continued to strengthen governance, grow our workforce, and support families through some of the most important work on the island.

I want to thank our Elders, our community members who share their stories, and the dedicated staff who show up every day with care and commitment. I also acknowledge our Board members for their steady leadership and accountability.

Together, we will keep building a future where Palm Islanders lead, culture is protected, and our young people can thrive.

— Luella Bligh
Board Chair

Luella

Luella Bligh

Community Voices

Meet the people who make Palm Island strong

 Aunty Maureen

Aunty Maureen

Cultural Elder



"Our stories are the foundation of everything we do. When the young ones learn our history, they learn who they are and where they belong."

[Read Aunty Maureen's Story →](#)

 David Thompson

David Thompson

Youth Program Graduate



"PICC believed in me when I didn't believe in myself. The youth program showed me there's a path forward, right here on Palm Island."

David's Journey →

 Sister Joyce

Sister Joyce

Health Worker



"Every day I see the difference we make. When someone gets the care they need, when a family is supported - that's what keeps me going."

Frontline Stories →

 Uncle Tommy

Uncle Tommy

Traditional Owner



"This land holds our ancestors' wisdom. Everything PICC does, we do it the right way - respecting Country, respecting culture."

Connection to Country →

 Sarah Williams

Sarah Williams

Safe Haven Coordinator



"These children are our future. When we protect them, support their families, we're building a stronger Palm Island for generations to come."

[Safe Haven Impact](#) →

 Marcus Johnson

Marcus Johnson

Digital Services Trainee



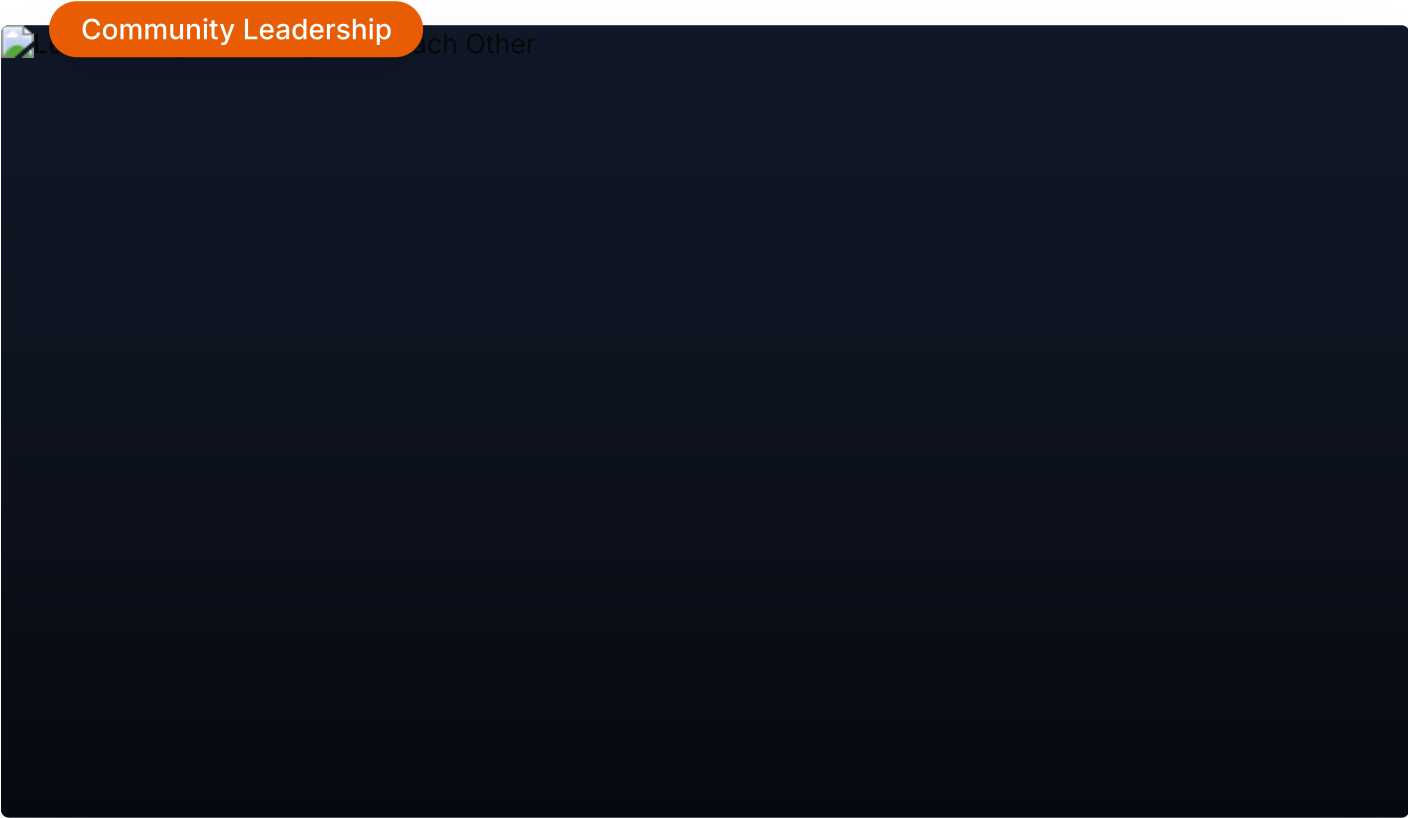
"Technology isn't just for the cities. Our Elders are now video calling their grandchildren on the mainland. That connection is everything."

[Bridging the Digital Gap](#) →



Leaders Learning Together

Sharing knowledge, strengthening connections



Services We Deliver

Supporting our community across all aspects of life

Our Impact at a Glance

Serving our community across multiple areas

48

Services

12

Categories

2,500

Clients Served

197

Dedicated Staff

health

family

community

justice

culture

other

education

employment

economic

housing

environment

youth



Bwgcorman Healing Service
health

Comprehensive primary healthcare integrating traditional and modern medicine



Bwgcorman Healing Service
health



Bwgcorman Healing Service
health

Comprehensive primary healthcare integrating traditional and modern medicine. Renamed from Primary Health Centre in early 2024 after extensive community consultation. RACGP accredited general practice clinic with wide range of health services including GP, specialist and allied health services.



Child Care Services
family

Early childhood education and care



Community Development
community

Community projects and initiatives



Community Health
health

Primary health care services



Community Justice
justice

Justice support and community safety initiatives



Community Justice Group
justice

Auspiced by PICC since 2008. Includes the general program and the Domestic and Family Violence Enhancement Program. Provides ongoing assistance to community members dealing with the criminal justice system.



Cultural Centre
culture

Cultural preservation, language programs, and arts



Cultural Programs
culture

Traditional culture and language programs



Digital Service Centre
other

Opened in 2023, provides sales and customer service for Telstra landline, mobile and Internet products for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander customers. Can connect callers with interpreters for about fifty First Nations languages. Second of its kind in Australia after Cherbourg.



Digital Service Centre
education

Technology access, digital literacy, and online services



Diversionary Service

justice

Provides diversionary support services to community members to reduce interactions with the justice system.



Early Childhood Services

education

Quality early childhood education and care through the Children and Family Centre (CFC). Presented "The Storyline of the Palm Island Children and Family Centre" at the 2023 SNAICC Conference in Darwin.



Early Learning Centre

education

Quality early childhood education and care



Economic Development

employment

Business support and economic initiatives



Economic Development

economic

Business support, employment, and economic opportunities



Education Support

education

Educational programs and tutoring



Elder Support Services

family

Support and care for Elders and seniors



Employment Services

employment

Job training and placement services



Family Care Service

family

Provides care and support services for families and children in need of out-of-home care placement.



Family Participation Program

family

Supports families to participate in decisions about their children and maintain connections.



Family Support

family

Family counseling and support services



Family Wellbeing Centre

family

Family support services and wellbeing programs



Family Wellbeing Centre

family

Provides comprehensive family support and wellbeing services to strengthen families on Palm Island.



Family Wellbeing Service

family

Support for families and children



Food Security

health

Community gardens, nutrition, and food programs



Housing Services

housing

Housing maintenance and tenancy support



Housing Support

community

Housing assistance and support



Language & Culture
culture

Language preservation and cultural education



Men's Programs
family

Healing and development programs for men



Mental Health Services
health

Mental health support and counseling



NDIS Service
other

National Disability Insurance Scheme support coordination, community connection and access services. Moved to new Aitkenvale office in February 2024 for better client service in Townsville region.



Ranger Program
environment

Land and sea country management and conservation



Safe Haven

youth

Provides safe accommodation and support for children and young people who need a safe place to stay.



Safe House

family

Emergency accommodation and support for those escaping domestic and family violence.



Social and Emotional Wellbeing Service

health

Provides mental health and social emotional wellbeing support services to community members.



Specialist Domestic and Family Violence Service

family

Specialist support for those affected by domestic and family violence.



Sport & Recreation

community

Sports programs and recreational activities



Sports & Recreation

youth

Sports programs and recreational activities



Transport Services
other

Community transport and mobility support



Women's Healing Service
family

Remodelled in 2024 to provide better services to women resident, or at risk of being resident, in the Townsville Women's Correctional Centre. Operates three programs: Re-entry Program, Women on Remand Program, and Early Intervention Program.



Women's Service
family

Support services specifically for women, including accommodation and outreach support.



Women's Services
family

Support and programs specifically for women



Youth Development
youth

Youth leadership and development programs



Youth Service

youth

Youth development, leadership, and support programs. Offers Young Offenders Support Service, Indigenous Youth Connection to Culture Program, Tackling Indigenous Smoking program, and Digital Footprint Program.



Youth Services

youth

Programs and support for young people



Youth Services

youth

Youth development, leadership, and support programs

Our Journey This Year

Key milestones and achievements



July 2023

New Financial Year Begins

PICC enters 2023-24 with expanded programs and renewed focus



September 2023

Digital Service Centre Opens

Bringing technology access and training to community members



November 2023

Storm Recovery Response

Community comes together to support families affected by severe weather



December 2023

150 Staff Milestone

Workforce growth demonstrates commitment to local employment



March 2024

Photo Studio Project Launch

Elders portrait project begins capturing community stories



May 2024

Health Services Expansion

New programs introduced to improve community health outcomes



June 2024

197 Staff Achievement

30% growth in local employment opportunities

A New Beginning for Our Little Ones

Palm Island's Early Learning Centre opens its doors



New Service Launch

Year in Pictures

Moments that captured the spirit of our community

-  Annual Community Day celebrations
-  Photo Studio - Capturing Elder stories
-  Health team delivering care
-  Youth Program graduation ceremony
-  Community comes together after the storm
-  Digital skills workshop for Elders
-  Early Learning Centre opening day
-  Leaders Trip - Learning from other communities

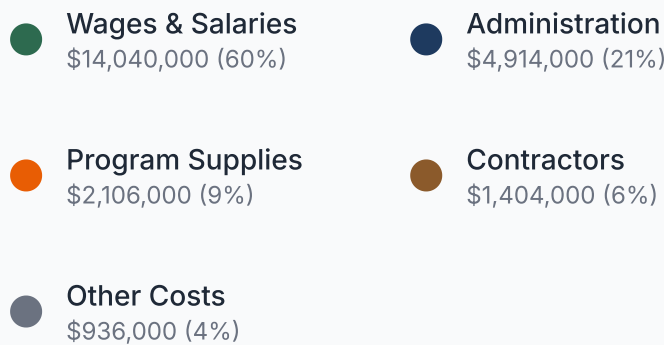
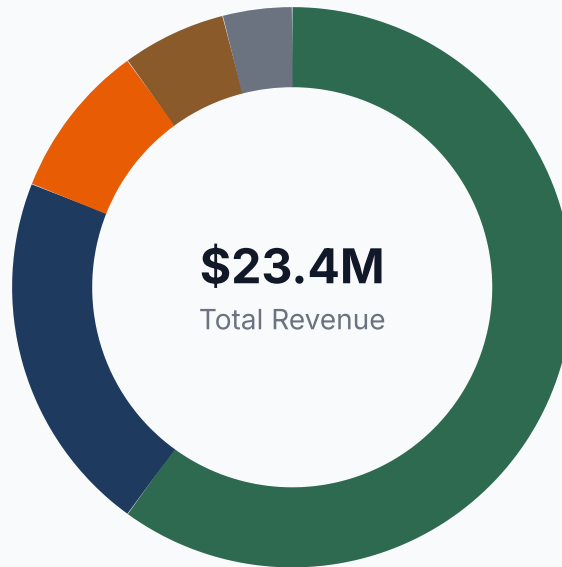


"The Photo Studio project gave me a chance to tell my story, to share what life was like when I was young. Now my grandchildren will always have that connection to their history."

Uncle Frank
Elder & Cultural Advisor

Financial Transparency

Where your support goes - every dollar makes a difference



Where Each Dollar Goes

60 cents of every dollar goes directly to staff wages

Staff Wages

60¢



Administration

21¢



Program Delivery

9¢



Specialist Services

6¢



Community Support

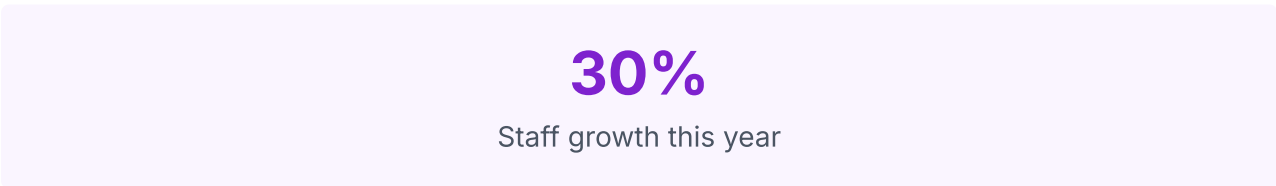
4¢



Total

100¢ = \$1.00

Financial Highlights



Impact by Category

Stories across our service areas

1

Youth

8

Elders

9

Culture

18

Community

2

Education



"Our vision is clear: a Palm Island where every person has the opportunity to thrive, where our culture is celebrated, and where our community leads its own future. Together, we are making this vision a reality."

Palm Island Community Company

Acknowledgments

****Traditional Owners****

We acknowledge the Manbarra people as the traditional owners of Palm Island and pay our respects to Elders past, present and emerging.

****Our Community****

We thank all Palm Islanders who trust PICC to serve them, and the many community members who shared their stories through our Empathy Ledger project.

****Our Funders****

We acknowledge the support of:

- Queensland Government
- NIAA (National Indigenous Australians Agency)
- Queensland Health
- Telstra
- Advance Queensland
- Northern Queensland Primary Health Network
- QATSI CPP (Queensland Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Child Protection Peak)

****Our Staff****

Thank you to our 197 dedicated staff members - 70%+ of whom are Palm Islanders - for your tireless work serving community.

****Our Board****

- Luella Bligh, Chair
- Rhonda Phillips, Director
- Allan Palm Island, Director
- Matthew Lindsay, Company Secretary
- Harriet Hulthen, Director

- Raymond W. Palmer Snr, Director

- Cassie Lang, Director

****In Memory****

We remember all those who came before us, including the survivors of Hull River who established this community in 1918.

Palm Island Community Company

ACN 640 793 728

<https://www.picc.com.au>



Palm Island (Bwgcolman), Queensland, Australia

"Our Community, Our Future, Our Way"

Palm Island Community Company © 2026



[Read More Stories](#)

[Learn More About PICC](#)

ABOUT PICC

Community-controlled organization serving Palm Island (Manbarra & Bwgcolman Country).

QUICK LINKS

[Stories](#)

[About](#)

[Impact](#)

RESOURCES

[Annual Reports](#)

[Ask AI](#)

[Knowledge Base](#)

GET INVOLVED

[Share Voice](#)

[Community](#)

[Subscribe](#)

[Contact](#)

CONNECT

 [Email](#)

© 2025 Palm Island Community Company. All rights reserved.

Manbarra & Bwgcolman Country